

POJI

Home and vehicle services, booked properly. Malta.

Malta has one home-services app and it books cleaners. Poji books 33 trades — electricians, plumbers, AC technicians, appliance repair, locksmiths, water filters, roadside callouts, transport, and cleaning.

The software is built and running. It needs payments switched on, providers on the ground, and twelve months of runway.

Investment sought: €100,000 for 20% of Pojico Ltd.

Yetkin Berberoglu · Malta · October 2026

The short version

What it is	One app to book a verified tradesperson in Malta, with the price fixed before anyone turns up and the money held until the work is approved.
Who pays	Households and small landlords. 20% commission on labour, 5% on parts.
Who supplies	Self-employed tradespeople already working in Malta, currently found through Facebook groups and word of mouth.
Why now	Malta grew to 588,254 people and 29.4% are foreign nationals with no local network to ask.
Why not already done	Malta’s one existing app does cleaning only. Twenty-eight other trades have no marketplace at all.
Built	Yes. Booking, verification, escrow logic, dispute handling, chat, notifications, admin. Live at po-ji.com.
Missing	Card payments (Stripe Connect under application), providers, clients.
Honest odds	Roughly one in two this becomes a small profitable business. Roughly one in five it becomes something larger. One in three it does not work.

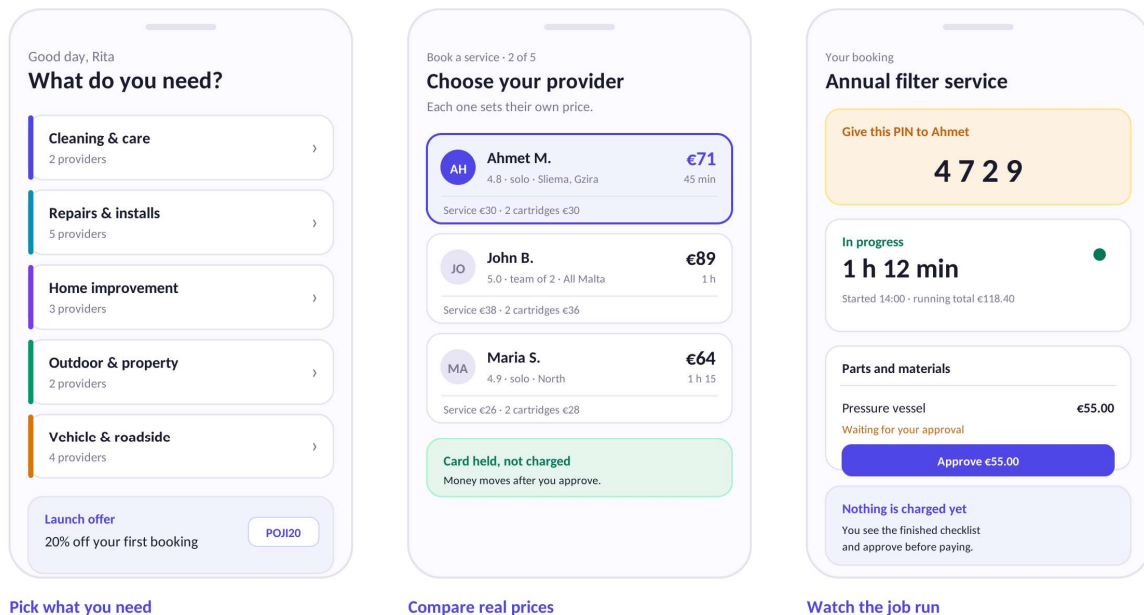
What Poji actually does

Booking a tradesperson in Malta today means asking a Facebook group, getting four replies, picking one on instinct, and having no idea what it will cost until they are standing in your hallway.

Poji replaces that with a booking. The client picks what they need, sees who does it with each provider's own price, picks a time, and confirms. Their card is held, not charged.

Three moments in a booking

The real screens: choosing a need, comparing providers who each set their own price, and the job running.



Pick what you need

Compare real prices

Watch the job run

Three screens from the working app. Each provider sets their own price, so the same job costs differently depending on who takes it.

The mechanics that make it work

Most of the build went into the parts that stop the obvious failures.

- A PIN at the door. The server generates a four-digit code the client reads out. The job only starts when the provider enters it. Nobody can bill for a visit that did not happen.
- The clock is the bill. Hourly work is timed from that PIN and settled on the server, rounded up to the quarter hour. The client watches the same clock the provider does.
- Parts need approval. A plumber who finds a failed valve adds it as a line; the client approves it before it reaches the bill. Parts carry 5% commission, not 20% — high enough to record, low enough that nobody bothers going around it.
- Money is settled server-side. Prices, commission and payouts are calculated in the database. Nothing the app sends can change what anyone is paid.
- A six-hour window. When work is marked done the client reviews a completed checklist and approves. Six hours of silence approves it automatically.
- Nobody shows up, nobody pays. Fifteen minutes past the hour the client can cancel at no cost, gets 10% off their next booking, and the no-show goes on the provider's record. Three ends in suspension.

- Messages are scanned. Phone numbers, IBANs and "let's do this off the app" are flagged for review. Contact details only open two hours before the job.

Three ways work gets priced

This is what separates Poji from a cleaning app, and it was the hardest part to get right.

Model	Used for	How
By the hour	Cleaning, gardening, handyman, man-and-van	Estimate up front, billed on real time
Fixed price	AC service, water filters, roadside, car valet	Provider sets their own price per service
Quoted	Rewires, bathrooms, house moves, appliance faults	They talk first, send a figure, nobody travels until it is accepted

Providers set their own prices, write their own questions, and list their own options. A water filter specialist who fits six-stage systems adds that option and prices it; the platform does not decide for them.

What Poji books

Thirty-three trades in five categories. One has a marketplace competitor in Malta. Thirty-two do not.

Cleaning & care 5 trades	Repairs & installs 9 trades	Home improvement 6 trades	Outdoor & property 5 trades	Vehicle & roadside 8 trades
- Cleaning RIVAL - Laundry & ironing - Window cleaning - Sofa & carpet - Pest control	- AC technician - Water filters - Electrician - Plumber - Appliance repair - Handyman - Furniture assembly - Locksmith - TV & satellite	- Painter - Carpenter - Tiler & marble - Aluminium works - Waterproofing - Curtains & blinds	- Gardening - Pool service - Solar water - Gas service - Moving & transport	- Mobile tyre fix - Battery service - Mobile mechanic - Towing - Fuel delivery - Car lockout - Car valet - VRT help

Malta's one existing home-services app covers the single orange box. Everything else is reached today through Facebook groups and word of mouth.

Twenty-eight of these have no marketplace competitor in Malta at all. The quoted jobs — a rewire, a bathroom, a full house move — carry commissions of several hundred euro each. One of those is worth forty cleans.

One household, many jobs

The breadth is the business, but not for the reason it first appears.

A cleaning app serves one moment in a household's year, repeatedly. That is a good business — cleaning recurs weekly and the relationship is sticky. It is also the only moment that app can serve. When the AC stops in July, when someone is locked out at midnight, when a tyre goes on the Coast Road, that app is no use and the household goes back to Facebook.

Poji is built for all of those moments, which changes three things.

Urgency gets the app installed

Nobody plans a puncture. Nobody schedules a lockout. These are the moments when a person will install an app in ninety seconds because the alternative is standing in the road ringing numbers from a Google result.

A cleaning app cannot capture that moment. Roadside work is a poor business on its own — low frequency, thin margins — but it is an excellent way to get onto a phone. Once Poji is installed for a flat tyre, booking a plumber six weeks later is one tap.

The second booking costs nothing to win

Acquiring a household is the expensive part. A cleaning app recovers that cost through repeat cleans. Poji recovers it across categories: an AC service in summer, a filter change in autumn, a plumber when a tap fails, a man-and-van when they move flat.

A household's year	Bookings	To Poji
AC service and a gas top-up	2	€22
Water filter service, twice	2	€33
Plumber or electrician callout	1	€14
Roadside, once	1	€9
Occasional deep clean	2	€24
Total from one household	8	€102

A household that books a weekly clean is worth more than this to a cleaning app — that is the honest comparison, and it is why cleaning is a good business. But that household has to be won against an incumbent with two years of reviews. The eight bookings above are won against nobody.

Higher value per job, where it is uncontested

Category	Typical booking	To Poji	Competition in Malta
Cleaning, 4 hours	€73	€12	Established app
AC service	€109	€11	None
Water filter, annual	€128	€17	None
Electrician, fuse board	€150–2,500	€30–500	None

House move, quoted	€250–2,500	€50–500	None
Roadside, puncture	€76	€9	None

Twenty-eight of the thirty-three trades have no marketplace competitor at all. That is where the margin is, and nobody is defending it.

The market

588,254	people in Malta and Gozo	NSO, end 2025
+2.4%	population growth in one year	NSO
29.4%	are foreign citizens	NSO
215,691	occupied dwellings	Census 2021
51,278	of those lived in by non-Maltese	Census 2021
84%	of homes have air conditioning, up from 52%	Census 2021

Why the foreign share matters more than the headcount

A Maltese family has a cousin who does tiling and a neighbour who fixes boilers. A Dutch compliance officer who moved to Sliema last year has neither. Nearly a quarter of occupied homes in Malta are lived in by someone who arrived recently, and the number has risen fivefold in a decade.

These are the people who already search, already pay by card, and already expect to book things on a phone. They are also the people who get overcharged most, because they have no way to tell a fair price from a chancer.

What the work is worth

Cleaning in Malta runs €12–€25 an hour through a platform, with a two-bedroom clean at €50–€120. Repairs, AC servicing and water filter work sit higher — €70 to €200 a visit. Roadside callouts run €40 to €90.

A conservative read: 215,691 occupied dwellings, a quarter of which buy some paid home service in a year, at an average of €240 a year. That is roughly €13 million of addressable spend. Poji needs well under one per cent of it to be a sound business.

Who else is doing this

There is a real competitor and it would be dishonest to bury it.

Rozie.app

Rozie is an established on-demand cleaning marketplace in Malta, with roughly 22,700 users, 140 or so active cleaners, coverage in Times of Malta, and apps on both stores. It has a two-year head start and it is good.

It is also cleaning only.

	Rozie	Poji
Trades covered	Cleaning	33, across five categories
Pricing models	Hourly and extras	Hourly, fixed, and quoted
Roadside	No	Yes, with GPS
Transport	No	Yes, priced by distance band
Provider sets own prices	Limited	Fully, including their own questions
Head start	Two years, ~22,700 users	None

The honest read on that

Poji will not win cleaning from Rozie by being a slightly better cleaning app. It should not try.

What Rozie has proved is more useful than what it has taken: Maltese households will book a tradesperson through an app and pay by card. That question is answered, and someone else paid to answer it.

The gap is everywhere else. Nobody in Malta is running a verified marketplace for electricians, plumbers, AC technicians, appliance repair, locksmiths, roadside work or transport. Those jobs still happen through Facebook groups, at a worse price, with no recourse.

Rozie would need to build three pricing models, a quoting flow, GPS dispatch, a parts-approval system and distance-band transport pricing to follow. That is most of a year of work, and it is work they have no reason to do while cleaning is growing. By the time it is worth their while, Poji should hold the trades that matter.

The strategy is to own the trades nobody has digitised, and let cleaning come later as a convenience for people already on the platform rather than as the beachhead.

Others

Simply Clean, Briiz, Malta Elite and similar are cleaning companies with booking forms, not marketplaces — they employ their own staff and do not scale past their payroll. Handy, Helping and the European platforms do not operate in Malta; the market is too small to be worth their localisation.

How the money works

Per booking

A booking	Client pays	Provider keeps	Poji keeps
Cleaning, 4 hours at €15	€73	€48	€12
Roadside puncture	€61	€40	€10
Water filter, annual service	€170	€118	€22
AC service, one unit	€182	€120	€30
Electrician, socket fitted	€164	€112	€23
AC gas top-up	€292	€206	€34
AC moved room to room	€304	€200	€50
AC installed, new unit	€425	€280	€70
House move, quoted	€850	€560	€140

VAT passes through — Poji collects 18% as a disclosed agent and remits it, so it is neither revenue nor cost. Card fees are shown to the client and passed to Stripe.

Across a realistic mix of trades, Poji nets about €28 a booking. The projections below use €25, which leaves room for the mix skewing towards cleaning.

This is where breadth shows up in the accounts, and the AC trade shows it most clearly. Having a unit moved from one room to another is quoted at €250 to €300 in Malta today, with no parts involved. Poji earns €50 on that single job — four times what it earns on a four-hour clean, and there is no app in Malta you can book it through.

What it costs to run

The team arrives in stages, so the monthly figure climbs over the first quarter. Month one also carries incorporation, legal review and the app store releases, which are paid once.

Every month, once running	Cost
Founder, full time	€3,000
Operations lead — recruits and supports providers, from month 3	€1,800
Part-time marketing and content, from month 4	€800
Provider recruitment — field work, sign-up incentives	€700
Client acquisition — social, expat groups, local press	€1,300
Launch promotions absorbed by Poji, not the provider	€400
Supabase, Vercel, Twilio, domains	€220
Accounting and VAT filing	€220
Platform liability insurance	€110
Monthly total from month 4	€8,550

The founder salary is €36,000 a year against a Maltese average wage of about €1,850 a month. It is a working wage for someone running the company full time, not a return on the investment — the return is in the equity.

At €25 a booking, break-even is about 342 bookings a month — roughly eleven a day across thirty-three trades.

Twelve months

Month	Bookings	Revenue	Costs	Net	Cumulative
1	0	€0	€8,850	-€8,850	-€8,850
2	30	€750	€5,950	-€5,200	-€14,050
3	80	€2,000	€7,750	-€5,750	-€19,800
4	150	€3,750	€8,550	-€4,800	-€24,600
5	230	€5,750	€8,550	-€2,800	-€27,400
6	320	€8,000	€8,550	-€550	-€27,950
7	400	€10,000	€8,550	€1,450	-€26,500
8	470	€11,750	€8,550	€3,200	-€23,300
9	540	€13,500	€8,550	€4,950	-€18,350
10	600	€15,000	€8,550	€6,450	-€11,900
11	660	€16,500	€8,550	€7,950	-€3,950
12	720	€18,000	€8,550	€9,450	€5,500

The month turns profitable around month seven. The deepest point is month six, €27,950 down, and the cumulative position is back above water by month twelve. That deepest point is the real funding requirement if the plan holds — the rest of the raise is cover for being wrong.

The low case is half these bookings: monthly break-even slips past month twelve and the hole reaches about €62,000 — still inside the raise. The high case is driven by one category running ahead of the rest. Roadside is the likeliest wedge because the need is urgent, but AC is where the money is: Malta has air conditioning in 84% of homes and no app to service any of it.

Where €100,000 goes

Where it goes	Monthly	Twelve months
People		
Founder, full time	€3,000	€36,000
Operations lead, from month 3	€1,800	€18,000
Part-time marketing, from month 4	€800	€7,200
Getting providers and clients		
Provider recruitment — field work, incentives	€700	€8,400
Client acquisition — social, expat groups, press	€1,300	€15,600
Launch promotions absorbed by Poji	€400	€4,800
Running it		
Supabase, Vercel, Twilio, domains	€220	€2,640
Accounting and VAT filing	€220	€2,640
Platform liability insurance	€110	€1,320
Paid once		
Company formation, Pojico Ltd	—	€600
Legal review of terms and provider agreement	—	€1,500
App Store and Play Store release	—	€800
Subtotal	—	€99,500
Contingency	—	€500
Total	—	€100,000

Every euro goes into the company. No part of this raise is paid out to the founder as consideration for the shares — the founder is paid a salary from the operating budget like anyone else, and takes the return in equity.

What €100,000 actually buys

Twelve months of operation whether or not a single booking happens. That is the point of the number and it is worth being plain about it.

If revenue comes in at...	Deepest cash hole	What is left at month 12
Plan (€105,000)	€27,950 in month 6	€105,500 — funds year two outright
Half of plan (€52,500)	€62,000 in month 12	€38,000 — funds four more months
Nothing at all	€100,000	€0 — twelve months were still paid for

Unspent money is not spent for the sake of it. If the plan holds, the balance extends runway well into year two or funds a first move off the island, and that is a decision to take with the investor at the time rather than to promise now.

What the money is really buying

Not software. The software exists and was built without outside money, which removes the risk that consumes most seed rounds. What this buys is twelve months in which one person works on Poji full time instead of on something that pays, a second person whose whole job is recruiting and keeping providers, and enough marketing to reach the point where the two sides bring each other.

What could go wrong

The cold start, which is the real risk

A marketplace with no providers is useless to clients, and a marketplace with no clients is useless to providers. Every two-sided business dies here if it dies.

The mitigation is narrow focus. Not 33 trades at launch — three, in two or three localities, with ten providers who have been met in person. Sliema, Gzira and St Julian's hold the densest concentration of exactly the foreign professionals who most need this.

Stripe

Connect approval is applied for and not granted. Without it there are no card payments, and taking cash would make commission uncollectable and the whole model unenforceable. If Connect is refused to a sole trader, incorporating first and re-applying adds four to six weeks and about €600.

Providers going around the platform

A cleaner who meets a client once can take the next booking in cash. The platform scans messages, holds contact details back until two hours before, and runs a documented penalty ladder. None of that is a cure; what actually holds people is that Poji brings work they would not otherwise get. A provider with a full book will leave. A provider with gaps in their week will not.

Market size

Malta is 588,000 people. A business here does not become large by staying here. The upside case depends on the same software working in Cyprus, Sicily or the Balearics — comparable islands, comparable informal trade markets, no incumbent. That is a second-round question, not a first-round one, and it should not be priced in now.

One founder

The platform was built by one person who also runs a car wash and drives for Uber. That is the reason it exists at all, and it is the single largest risk in the business. The first hire should be an operations person who can recruit and manage providers, so that the founder is not the only point of failure.

The honest odds

No investor is helped by a number pulled from the air, so here is the reasoning rather than a figure.

What is already true: the product is built and works, which removes the risk that eats most seed money. The founder has run service businesses in Malta and knows the trades personally. The market has been validated by a competitor. The regulatory model — VAT agency, disclosed invoicing — is worked out. The commission mechanics cannot be gamed from a phone.

What is not yet true: no payments, no users, no company, no team, and a competitor with a two-year head start in the largest single category.

Outcome	Chance	What it looks like
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Does not work	~30%	Never passes 100 bookings a month. Money is spent, software remains.
A small, real business	~45%	500 to 1,000 bookings a month, €2,000–€12,000 monthly profit, two or three people. A good living, a modest return.
Grows past Malta	~20%	Malta works, the model is exported to one or two comparable islands. Worth a real multiple.
Large	~5%	Becomes the default across several small European markets. Acquisition or a proper round.

Weighted honestly, this is not a venture-scale bet and should not be sold as one. It is a sound small-market business with a built product, a real gap, and a founder who has already done the hard part without funding. The most likely good outcome is a profitable company in Malta, not an exit.

The ask

€100,000 for 20% of Pojico Ltd, to be incorporated on completion. That values the company at €500,000.

Twelve months of runway. Month one incorporates, closes Stripe Connect and recruits the first ten providers in person. Months two and three launch in three localities across three trades. Months four to eight widen the trades and the map. Months nine to twelve push for monthly profit and settle whether there is a second market worth entering.

On the valuation: €500,000 for a pre-revenue company is at the upper end, and an investor may well say so. The case for it is that the product is finished, the regulatory model is worked out, and the money goes to customers rather than to building. The case against it is that there are no users yet. It is a fair argument to have, and the number is negotiable.

What triggers a conversation about more money

- 400 bookings in a single month — the point where the month pays for itself, or
- 50 active providers with a job each in the past fortnight, or
- Any single category passing 150 bookings a month

Any of those says the thing works and is worth pushing harder, whether that means a second market or simply more marketing in this one. None of them by month twelve says the opposite, and that conversation should be just as honest as this one.

Yetkin Berberoglu · po-ji.com · Malta

Sources: National Statistics Office Malta (population estimates to end 2025; Census of Population and Housing 2021). Competitor figures are as published by Rozie.app. Projections are the author's own and are not guarantees.